

around installed devices is contained in Microsoft's Device Manager. If there exists a system that has FreeBSD as the only installed operating system, one can make use of `dmesg` to find out the hardware that was listed and discovered during the boot probe process. The majority of device drivers on the FreeBSD environment contain a manual page that sheds light on all the hardware supported by that driver. One more tool that users can invoke in order to obtain a more comprehensive output with respect to the hardware details is `pciconf`.



Image Source: groovypost.com

The configuration file

- One needs to first install the complete FreeBSD source tree before they can formulate the custom kernel configuration file or develop a custom kernel.
- Post completing the installation of the source, one is encouraged to scan through the contents of `/usr/src/sys`. This directory is inclusive of several subdirectories, accommodating all those that represent the supported architectures of `i386`, `sparc64`, `amd64`, and `powerpc`.
- All the information that is contained inside the directory of a particular architecture strictly revolves around the tenets of that specific architecture.
- The remaining code, is in essence, the machine independent code common across all platforms.
- Additionally, the generic kernel configuration file for every supported architecture is contained inside a 'conf' subdirectory that it holds. Users are advised to make no edits to the generic configuration file.
- Instead, they should copy the files to a separate name and subsequently perform all relevant edits over there.